



TIPS & TRICKS



Using the proxy server via the command line

Often administrators need to use the proxy server via the command line. For this purpose, we can use the 'export' command. Open the '.bashrc' file in your text editor by using the following command from your terminal:

```
vi ~/.bashrc
```

Then add the following four lines at the end of your '.bashrc' file in your home folder:

```
export http_proxy="http://username:password@
proxyserver:port"
export https_proxy="https://username:password@
proxyserver:port"
export ftp_proxy="ftp://username:password@proxyserver:port"
export socks_proxy="socks://username:password@
proxyserver:port"
```

This will make all your applications use the proxy to access the Internet.

—Nagaraju Dhulipalla, nagarajunice@gmail.com



Enable the EPEL repository in CentOS/Red Hat

Many a time, we need to install additional packages on GNU/Linux distributions but installing them from unknown repositories is not safe. This is where the EPEL (Extra Packages for Enterprise Linux) repository comes to the rescue. All EPEL packages are maintained by Fedora and can be installed on RHEL, CentOS, Scientific Linux and other RPM based distributions. One of the biggest advantages is that the repository is 100 per cent open source and free to use. Additionally, it does not provide any core duplicate packages and has no compatibility issues. So let us configure the EPEL repository in CentOS.

To enable the EPEL repository, we need to download and install the RPM package. The following commands can be used on CentOS 7.x:

```
[root]# wget http://dl.fedoraproject.org/pub/epel/7/
```

```
x86_64/e/epel-release-7-10.noarch.rpm
[root]# rpm -ivh epel-release-7-10.noarch.rpm
```

If you are using CentOS 6.x, then the following command will do the needful:

```
[root]# wget http://download.fedoraproject.org/pub/epel/6/
x86_64/epel-release-6-8.noarch.rpm
[root]# rpm -ivh epel-release-6-8.noarch.rpm
```

That's it. The EPEL repository is now enabled on your system. We can verify it by listing the configured repositories.

```
[root]# yum repolist
```

—Narendra Kangraalkar, narendrakangraalkar@gmail.com



Finding syntax errors in .php pages

Here is a simple command to help you find syntax errors in .php pages:

```
find -type f -name "*.php" -exec php -l '{}' \; | grep '^^[^N]'
```

—Remin Raphael, remin13@gmail.com



How to create dialogue boxes using Zenity and notify-send

Zenity enables the user to create various types of simple dialogue boxes that interact graphically with the user. These include notification, message and text information dialogue boxes.

Shown below is an example of a Zenity text information dialogue box:

```
$zenity --info --text "good morning"
--text-info
```

...displays the text information dialogue with the text